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Gov. JB Pritzker speaks to the congregation at the Apostolic Church of God in Woodlawn on Sunday. Pritzker touted his record as a foil to President Donald Trump as the governor looked to shore up Democratic support on the final weekend before Election Day.



Republican candidate for governor Darren Bailey and his wife, Cindy Bailey, right, speak to a supporter before holding a news conference in front of the hotel venue for a socialism conference in Chicago on Friday. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

Campaigns begin final push

On weekend before midterm Election Day, Illinois Democrats rally and knock on doors while many top Republicans stay quiet

By Rick Pearson, Olivia Olander, Dan Petrella and Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Politicians across the Illinois ballot used the final weekend before Tuesday's general election embarking on a closing-hours effort to turn out their political bases with rallies, church visits and door-knocking, while Gov. JB Pritzker took his case to a national Sunday television audience.

Appearing on NBC's "Meet the Press," the two-term Democrat looked past Tuesday's rematch with Republican Darren Bailey, whom he vanquished by about 13 percentage points four years ago, and did nothing to dispel talk of a 2028 presidential bid.

"Because that (2028) election is so important, I'm going to work my tail off to make sure that we have a Democrat who will win and make sure that that Democrat does in fact win. And I've done that in every presidential election really since I was an adult and able to vote. So I'll continue on that path," Pritzker said.

Touting strong Democratic early and mail-in voting nationally, including in traditionally Republican states, Pritzker predicted Democrats would wrest control of both the U.S. House and Senate from Republicans. He also urged a Democratic-led Congress to hold hearings on alleged corruption in President Donald Trump's administration, but he stopped short of calling for Trump's impeachment.

"The energy on the ground, not just in Illinois but across the country, is very high. We're seeing an overperformance of Latino voters, overperformance of young voters, of Black voters. This is good for Democrats," said the wealthy governor, who has pumped millions of dollars into races nationally. Accusing Trump of attempting to rig the midterm results for the GOP, Pritzker said, "that's why everybody's got to get out and vote. And I do see that people really are. The early voting is just off the charts."

But Pritzker's enthusiastic comments came shortly before new turmoil erupted in Michigan, where Democrats are trying to hold a seat critical to their hopes of taking the Senate.

U.S. Rep. Haley Stevens, who narrowly lost the state's Democratic Senate primary to Abdul El-Sayed, issued a late endorsement of the Trump-backed Republican in the race, former U.S. Rep. Mike Rogers, appearing with him at a predominantly Black church in Detroit on Sunday.

The Michigan contest has been marked by controversial attacks on El-Sayed, who is Muslim, and by escalating tensions between him and Stevens, a strong supporter of Israel. Stevens had previously vowed to back the Democratic ticket.

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Dem backs Republican in Mich.

El-Sayed's former rival for Senate stuns party by endorsing Rogers

By Joey Cappelletti, Corey Williams and Mike Householder
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DETROIT — Michigan Democrat Abdul El-Sayed's former opponent in the U.S. Senate primary, Haley Stevens, stunned party officials Sunday by endorsing Republican Mike Rogers after Democratic tensions boiled over days before the election that could determine the balance of power on Capitol Hill.

Stevens endorsed Rogers after attending a Detroit church service with him. The remarkable show of support for the President Donald Trump-backed candidate in the tightly contested race comes after she was uninvited to a joint event the same day with El-Sayed, who defeated the congresswoman by a slim margin in the August primary.

"Our Democratic nominee for Senate said I was no longer welcome in his campaign and that I should stay away," Stevens said in a video announcing the endorsement, which led her top aide to quit. "And he's right. And that's why I am endorsing Mike Rogers for the United States Senate today."

El-Sayed dismissed the endorsement when asked about it by reporters later Sunday, saying he's focused on issues that voters care about, such as the high cost of living.

"At the end of the day I actually don't think about Haley Stevens," he said, adding later: "None of this matters."

Tensions between the two Democrats have festered since

See **SENATE** on Page A9



Republican Senate candidate Mike Rogers, right, and Rep. Haley Stevens, D-Mich., on Sunday in Detroit. **JOSE JUAREZ/AP**

Meal kit firm on the rise again after leaner times

Home Chef, based in Chicago, is whipping up new recipes to keep millennials cooking

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE



Research and development chef Daryll Tinana works on a new recipe at the Home Chef test kitchen in Chicago on Sept. 17. Founded in 2013, Chicago-based Home Chef has grown into one of the leading meal kit companies in the nation. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Home Chef, a Chicago-based meal kit company that saw its subscription service fall off in the wake of the pandemic, is growing again with a plethora of front door-to-table options to keep its target millennial customers cooking.

In addition to classic meal kits that make everything from umami tortellini in truffle butter sauce to sesame miso chicken in the time it takes Uber Eats to deliver dinner, a newer Home Chef microwavable line can be ready faster than you can place a restaurant order.

"We know people are preparing these oftentimes on weeknights, they don't want to spend two hours in the kitchen," said Rich DeNardis, chief revenue officer of Home Chef. "It depends on the meal, but we're targeting 30 minutes or less."

Founded in 2013, Home Chef is one of the leading meal kit companies in the nation, with a bustling Old Post Office headquarters, a Bedford Park manufacturing plant, four distribution centers and more than 2,000 employees creating ready-to-prepare entrees.

Home Chef, which was acquired by Kroger in 2018, is projected to top $700 million in sales this year through its $9.99-per-serving online meal kit subscription service. Tempo, a microwavable offering introduced in 2023, accounts for about 15% of revenue, the company said.

Subscribers must order at least two meal kits per week from a rotating menu featuring dozens of recipes with pre-portioned ingredients and step-by-step directions. The meal kits are packed on ice

See **MEALS** on Page A2

Lawsuit alleges 'torture' of ICE detainees at prison

Indiana facility holds immigrants pending deportation, many from Chicago area

By Laura Rodríguez Presa
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For nearly two months, Omar was detained at the Miami Correctional Facility in Indiana before being deported to Mexico. He had lived in the Chicago area since he was a child.

Now 49, Omar recalled during a phone interview with the Tribune his final days in U.S. immigration custody.

"It was miserable, I really thought I wasn't going to make it," he said, his voice cracking as he spoke from Mexico City. Omar, whose last name is being withheld because he fears retaliation if he ever returns to the U.S., said for much of his detention, officials failed to provide him with the medication he must take to maintain his liver transplant and control his diabetes.

He described a hostile and unsanitary environment where people detained for civil immigration violations go hungry, become sick and, in some instances, become suicidal.

A new class-action lawsuit against the federal government and Indiana officials condemns conditions inside the Miami

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NATION & WORLD

Judge dismisses Trump's Alaska suit

A federal judge on Sunday dismissed a Justice Department lawsuit seeking to block certification of Alaska's U.S. Senate race if Republican incumbent Sen. Dan Sullivan loses. **Page B1**

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